

Presidents Report 2016/17

Once again the year has rolled around and another season is upon us. This time last year there was some doubt whether we would have a club, well what a difference a year makes.

For the first time in years we managed to fill all the positions with the election of officers and committee, as a committee we hit the ground running so to speak.

We changed the constitution to bring it into line with Athletics NZ, we became an Incorporated Society which has helped when applying for funding and we also designed and introduced a new club singlet.

When we were last audited we were advised that one of our goals for the season was to become more financial, which I am proud to say has been achieved. I would like to thank Natasha and John for keeping the books in order and the impressive end of year financial report which will be read out later.

We applied to Mainpower, Rata foundation and Aoraki Trust for funding, all applications were successful which enabled us to purchase hoodies for the children, a new high jump mat and also purchase plenty of singlets for the future.

Moving onto the Cross Country and Road season, numbers were down on previous years but what we lacked in quantity was more than made up by the quality of performances. We had age group champions and place getters in the Canterbury Champs and other events. The season ended on a high with the senior women's winning the Tahake to Akaroa road relay.

We only had a couple of competitors competing in the summer. Well done to Najavo who was selected for the Canterbury team that competed in the National Track and Field Champs in Hamilton and performed with credit.

I will just touch briefly on the children's section as I have asked them to do their own report on their season.

It was great to see an increase in the summer registrations for the children and it appears we may have a couple of them competing in the winter. There were some fantastic results in the Colgate and Canterbury Champs. I had a phone call from a Canterbury Executive who asked me to pass on how impressed she was with this group of children and that they were a credit to our club.

While still on the juniors I would like to thank Marian and especially Jo our children's coaches. The children's performances have come down to the time and effort you have both put in. Denise Pawsey also requires a big thank you for not only being a great secretary but also the work she has done over the summer organising the parents and children. The parents also deserve a big pat on the back for their help on practice nights and Saturdays. Well done to all involved.

I would now like to say a big thank you to the committee for all your hard work and support over the year. It has been very much a team effort. We have had a busy 12 months and achieved a hell of a lot. As president I am very proud of what we have achieved as a committee and a club.

Our goal is to keep growing the club and from what I am hearing we have interest from potentially new members and some returning members. I consider we have had a successful year, good luck to everyone and thanks for your continued support of the club.

Regards

Chris Rae

President